

News Weekly

Camden charter school seeks help after flooding forces move

Hope Community Charter School in Camden, New Jersey, is urgently seeking public assistance after severe flash flooding forced them to relocate just weeks before the school year begins. This unexpected move has already delayed the start of classes, and the school is racing to relocate across the city. The flooding, which occurred post-Fourth of July weekend, inundated the ground floor, damaging walls, classrooms, and supplies. Serving 110 students from kindergarten through eighth grade, the school now requires community support for moving trucks, professional movers, supplies, and volunteers. Principal Jennifer Smith emphasized the need for immediate help, while special education teacher Audrey Szabo expressed hope for sponsorship to cover moving services. Despite these challenges, the staff is committed to ensuring a successful year for their students. To assist, please call 856-379-3448 or email szabo@hopecommunitycharter.org. (ABC)



80 million year old fossil shows early snake diversity

The evolution of snakes, descended from modified lizard ancestors, remains a fascinating puzzle in the scientific community. With over 4,000 species today, their long, limbless bodies have sparked debates about their origins, either underground or aquatic. Recent findings published in *Nature* suggest a more complex evolutionary journey, with early snakes inhabiting diverse environments and developing varied sensory adaptations. A significant discovery is the fossil of *Tametara mirim* from the Late Cretaceous in Brazil. Through advanced imaging techniques, researchers reconstructed its brain anatomy, revealing adaptations for burrowing. Comparisons with *Dinilysia patagonica* from Argentina showed distinct brain structures, indicating different lifestyles. These studies illustrate that early snakes explored multiple habitats, evolving unique adaptations well before the modern snake body form emerged, showcasing diverse evolutionary strategies rather than a singular path (Science Daily).



This school-bus-sized "terror croc" ate dinosaurs. Now it's back

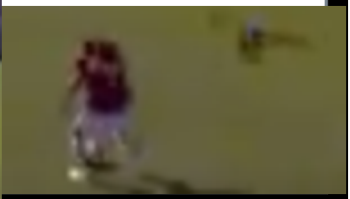
A life-size, scientifically accurate reconstruction of *Deinosuchus schwimmeri*, a giant crocodilian predator, has been unveiled at the Tellus Science Museum in Cartersville, Georgia. This formidable creature, which lived in the eastern United States between 83 and 76 million years ago, was a top predator in its ecosystem, capable of preying on dinosaurs due to its immense size and powerful jaws. Resembling a colossal alligator, *Deinosuchus* belonged to an ancient lineage of crocodilians. The replica's creation was overseen by Dr. David Schwimmer, a leading expert on *Deinosuchus*, in collaboration with Triebold Paleontology Inc. This unique exhibit provides visitors, especially school groups, with an immersive glimpse into the Cretaceous Period, enhancing their understanding of the region's prehistoric environment. "Tellus is currently the only museum to have a cast of *Deinosuchus schwimmeri*, so this is an experience our visitors can't get anywhere else," noted Rebecca Melsheimer, the museum's curatorial coordinator. (Science Daily)



Rogue parrot attacks players during Brazilian U-15 soccer game, then comes back and does it again

In an unexpected twist during a Brazil Under-15 Cup match between Flamengo and Ceará, a parrot repeatedly disrupted the game, creating a mix of comedy and chaos. The large bird swooped in, targeting players and causing the referee to pause the match multiple times. Despite the avian interruptions, Flamengo managed to secure a 1-0 victory. This unusual event added an exciting, albeit bizarre, element to youth soccer, leaving spectators with a memorable story. This incident humorously highlighted the unpredictable nature of live sports and perhaps hinted at a new, albeit unintended, way to engage audiences.

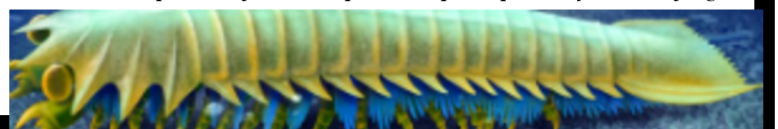
(FOX)



518-million-year-old creature reveals the origins of spider fangs

Researchers from Yunnan University and the University of Leicester have uncovered the earliest known evidence of proto-spider fangs in a 518-million-year-old fossil. The fossil belongs to *Urokodia*, a marine creature from the early Cambrian Period, unearthed at the Chengjiang fossil site in China. Although *Urokodia* measured just 2-3 cm and bore little resemblance to modern spiders and scorpions, X-ray analysis revealed pincer-like appendages behind its eyes, marking the primitive beginnings of chelicerae—the specialized limbs that evolved into the fangs and pincers seen in today's chelicerates like spiders and scorpions. This discovery highlights the ancient origins of these formidable hunters, which have diversified into a successful animal group inhabiting both marine and terrestrial environments. Despite their fearsome reputation, spiders primarily use their fangs to subdue small prey, posing minimal threat to humans.

(Science Daily)



Jokes

What did the egg say to the clown?

“I’m really cracking up!”.

Nasa Games



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Masala Coconut Fish Curry

Ingredients

- - 600 grams cod fillets, cut into 4 cm pieces
- - 200 grams onions, finely chopped
- - 15 grams ginger-garlic paste
- - 10 grams garam masala
- - 5 grams turmeric powder
- - 400 ml full-fat coconut milk
- - 100 grams ripe tomatoes, pureed
- - 30 ml vegetable oil
- - 5 grams green chilies, slit (optional, for heat)
- - 2 grams salt, or to taste

Instructions

1. Heat oil in a large pan over medium heat. Add chopped onions and sauté until golden brown, about 8-10 minutes.
2. Stir in ginger-garlic paste and green chilies (if using), cook for 2 minutes until fragrant.
3. Add garam masala and turmeric powder. Cook for 1 minute, stirring constantly to prevent burning.
4. Pour in tomato puree and cook until the oil separates from the mixture, about 5-7 minutes.
5. Add coconut milk and bring to a gentle simmer. Season with salt.
6. Carefully add the fish pieces to the simmering sauce. Do not stir vigorously to prevent breaking the fish.
7. Cover the pan and cook for 8-10 minutes, or until the fish is cooked through and flakes easily.
8. Gently stir to combine the flavors, being careful not to break the fish.
9. Serve hot with steamed rice or naan bread.

Pro tips

- For a richer flavor, toast the garam masala lightly in a dry pan before adding it to the curry.
- To ensure the fish stays intact, use a firm white fish like cod or mahi-mahi and avoid over-stirring.
- Taste and adjust salt and spice levels at the end of cooking for perfect balance.

